Information Sheet for Student Participants

Investigating Children's Agency when learning with AI

What is our study about?

When you use AI tools, like chatbots, to help you learn, it can be easy to let the AI make the decisions for you. We want to understand how a learning application can help you stay in charge — making your own choices, setting your own goals, and deciding how to learn. We are testing an application designed to support this, and we want to learn how it changes the way you make choices and feel about your learning over five weeks.

You'll be using our learning application for five weeks, either as part of your learning from school or on your own (if you joined through your parent/carer). This is not assessed and won't affect you at school If you decide to join we will ask you to:

- Fill in a short questionnaire about yourself, and a short questionnaire about how you make choices and feel about your learning — once at the start and the same one again at the end.
- Attend a short session at the start where we explain the study and show you the application.
- Use our learning application over the five weeks.

We are also asking a smaller group to tell us more about their experience in more detail.

If you are invited to join that group, you would:

- Have a short chat with a researcher each week (about 15–20 minutes) about how you've been using the application and the choices you've made.
- Have a longer chat of about 20–30 minutes at the end.

Being in that group is a separate choice, you can say no and still take part in everything else.

Do I have to take part?

No. Taking part is completely voluntary. If you don't want to take part, you don't have to, and no one will mind. If you decide to take part and later change your mind, you can stop at any time during the study, and up to two weeks after your final session, without giving a reason and without any effect on you, your grades or your relationship with your school.

If your parent or carer agrees, they will be asked to sign a consent form, and you will also be asked to sign, what is called an 'assent' form, to show that you understand what is involved and are happy to take part.

What will happen to my answers?

With your permission, your interview is audio-recorded so we can remember what you said. The recording is typed up and then deleted once we have checked it. You never have to answer a question you don't want to, and you can stop a chat at any time.

Everything you tell us is kept confidential within the limits allowed by law. We keep your name on a separate, secure list only for a short time so that you can withdraw if you want to or for safeguarding. A

short time after the study is over this list is deleted and your data becomes fully anonymous, so there is no way for anyone to connect your answers to you. We use a study ID, a code number, instead of your name in all analysis.

One thing to know: what you type into the application is stored, and the research team can read it. It's also checked automatically for **anything that suggests you or someone else might not be safe. If we see something like that, we have to tell someone who can help, usually someone at your school, a parent/carer, or any other appropriate service. That's the only time we cannot keep what you write private.** Please use the application for schoolwork or your own project but don't type in personal information about yourself or other people.

Anonymised data (with your name removed) — including your questionnaire answers and how you used the application — may be combined with other students' answers and used in future research by our team or other researchers. At the end of the study, we will tell you what we found.

For more about your data and privacy, see the UCL privacy notice

What if I want to take part but my parent has not given consent?

If you're taking part through your school and you want to join but your parent or carer has not given consent, you can still speak to your teacher before the study begins. You would be able to use the application and join in all the activities like everyone else — but the data from students without parental consent will not be used in the research.

Who is running this study?

We are a team of researchers at University College London (UCL), working with colleagues at the University of Oxford. We study how young people learn and make choices when they use AI tools.

Principal Investigator: Professor Manolis Mavrikis, UCL Knowledge Lab, m.mavrikis@ucl.ac.uk

UCL Co-Investigators: Dr. Zaki Pauzi; Dr. Vidminas Vizgirda; Ms Yildiz Uzun; Ms Rahki Nair; Dr Kyrill Potapov

Collaborators (University of Oxford): Dr. Jun Zhao (University of Oxford); Dr. Leslye Dias Duran (University of Oxford); Dr. Isobel Voysey (University of Oxford)

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This project has been reviewed and approved by the UCL IOE Research Ethics Committee (ref. Z6364106/2026/09/12) and UCL Data Protection Office (ref. Z6364106/2026/10/135 social research).

Contact for further information

UCL Principal Investigator

Professor Manolis Mavrikis

Email: **m.mavrikis@ucl.ac.uk**

What if I'm worried or want to complain?

If you have any concerns or complaints about the conduct of this project, you are welcome to contact the UCL IOE Research Ethics Office:

Executive Officer

UCL IOE Research Ethics Office

UCL Institute of Education

University College London

20 Bedford Way

London WC1H 0AL

United Kingdom

Email: ioe.researchethics@ucl.ac.uk

Thank you very much for taking the time to read this information sheet!